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Assembly for fixing beams, including a support plate and two fixings on respective opposite sides of the support plate

Abstract

An assembly including a support plate through which passes an opening with two faces parallel to a bearing plane, a first fixing fixed against the first face, first sleeves receiving beams, and a stud with a hole having an axis, a second fixing against the second face, second sleeves receiving beams, a housing for the stud and a clamping screw screwed into the hole, with the axis at an angle (α) to the bearing plane between 10° and 80° inclusive. The assembly forms a chassis which may be fixed to a propulsion assembly and a wing of an aircraft.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCES TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application claims the benefit of French Patent Application Number 2304043 filed on Apr. 21, 2023, the entire disclosure of which is incorporated herein by way of reference.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(2) The present invention concerns an assembly for fixing beams to a support plate, including the support plate and two fixings fixed on respective opposite sides of the support plate and in which each fixing includes at least one sleeve for a beam. The present invention also concerns a chassis for a propulsion assembly of an aircraft as well as an aircraft including a propulsion assembly including such a chassis.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(3) An aircraft classically includes at least one propulsion assembly comprising an engine fastened to a chassis, more commonly referred to as a pylon, fixed to a structure of a wing of the aircraft.

- Such a chassis takes for example the form of a cage one embodiment of which is represented in FIG. 5. The chassis **500** includes a plurality of formers or ribs **502**, here five of them, disposed one after the other along a longitudinal direction of the aircraft and, between two successive formers **502**, beams or longerons **504** fixed by their ends to the two successive formers **502**.
- (4) The beams **504** are fixed to each former **502** by fixings fixed to the former **502** one embodiment of which is represented in FIG. 6. FIG. 6 shows a former **502** and two beams **504** fixed on respective opposite sides of the former **502** at the level of the same fixing point by means of a first fixing **602a** and a second fixing **602b**. The former **502** has a first surface **502a** inscribed in a first plane and a second surface **502b** inscribed in a second plane parallel to the first plane.
- (5) The first fixing **602a** has a first base **604a** that is fixed to the former **502** by a plurality of fixing means **606a** such as bolts. The first base **604a** bears against the first surface **502a** of the former **502**. Opposite the first surface **502a** the first fixing **602a** has two sleeves **608a** fastened to the first base **604a**, each receiving inside it an end of a beam **504**.
- (6) The second fixing **602b** has a second base **604b** that bears against the second surface **502b** of the former **502** opposite the first surface **502a**. The second fixing **602b** is fixed to the first fixing **602a** by a screw **610** with a head and a threaded shank, the threaded shank passing through the second fixing **602b** and the former **502**, to be screwed into a threaded hole of the first fixing **602a**, and the head coming to bear against a part of the second fixing **602b** so as to sandwich the former **502** between the first fixing **602a** and the second fixing **602b**. Opposite the second surface **502b** the second fixing **602b** includes two sleeves **608b** fastened to the second base **604b** and each receiving inside it one end of a beam **504**.
- (7) The first fixing **602a** also includes a centering stud **612** that fits in a hole of the second fixing **602b** provided for this purpose.
- (8) Even if such an arrangement proves satisfactory, the design is such that the screw **610** must be perpendicular to the former **502** and, because of the overall size, all the beams **504** are at an angle to the former **502** and it is not possible to have a beam perpendicular to said former **502**.
- (9) It is therefore desirable to find an arrangement that frees up the position of the beams and allows for example a position of the beam perpendicular to the former.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

- (10) One object of the present invention is to propose an assembly for fixing beams in which there is greater freedom for orienting the beams.
- (11) To this end there is proposed an assembly for fixing beams, including: a support plate through which an opening passes and having a first face and a second face opposite the first face, the two faces being parallel to a bearing plane, a first fixing including a first base fixed against the first face by fixing means, on the side opposite the first face, at least one first sleeve intended to receive inside it one end of a beam, and a stud extending through said opening and including a hole with an axis, a second fixing including a second base bearing against the second face and, on the side opposite the second face, at least one second sleeve fastened to the second base and intended to receive inside it one end of a beam, and a housing in which said stud is housed and which includes a clamping wall through which passes a hole facing said hole, and a clamping screw screwed into the hole and sandwiching the clamping wall, the axis being at an angle to the bearing plane between 10° and 80° inclusive and preferably between 30° and 60° inclusive.
- (12) With such an arrangement the clamping screw is obliquely positioned relative to the bearing plane which, among other things, allows the placement of beams perpendicular to the bearing plane.
- (13) The hole is advantageously coaxial with one of the sleeves of the first fixing.
- (14) The head of the clamping screw is advantageously housed in a bushing of the second fixing one of the cylindrical surfaces of which carries a first thread and the assembly advantageously includes an additional beam one end of which carries a second thread complementary to the first thread.

- (15) The stud advantageously has an exterior surface that fits inside an interior surface of the housing and in that the exterior surface and the interior surface are parallel to the axis of the hole.
- (16) The stud advantageously has an exterior surface that fits inside an interior surface of the housing and the exterior surface and the interior surface are both advantageously perpendicular to the bearing plane.
- (17) The invention also proposes a chassis for fixing a propulsion assembly to a wing of an aircraft, said chassis including a plurality of formers and a plurality of beams with the beams fixed to the formers by means of assemblies according to any one of the preceding variants, each former constituting a support plate and each sleeve receiving inside it one end of a beam.
- (18) The invention also proposes aircraft including a chassis according to the preceding variant, a propulsion assembly and a wing, with the propulsion assembly fixed to the chassis and the chassis fixed to the wing.
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Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The features of the invention mentioned hereinabove and others will become more clearly apparent on reading the following description of one embodiment, said description being given with reference to the appended drawings, in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a side view of an aircraft in accordance with the invention including a propulsion assembly,
- (3) FIG. 2 is a side view of an assembly in accordance with a first embodiment of the invention,
- (4) FIG. 3 is a view in section of the assembly from FIG. 2,
- (5) FIG. 4 is a view in section of an assembly in accordance with a second embodiment of the invention,
- (6) FIG. 5 is a perspective view of a chassis for an aircraft engine, and
- (7) FIG. 6 is a side view of a prior art assembly.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

- (8) In the following description terms relating to a position refer to an aircraft in the attitude of forward movement, that is to say as represented in FIG. 1, where the arrow F shows the direction of forward movement of the aircraft.
- (9) In the following description, and by convention, X denotes the longitudinal direction that corresponds to the axis of the aircraft oriented positively toward the front in the direction of forward movement of the aircraft, Y denotes the transverse direction that is horizontal when the aircraft is on the ground, and Z denotes the vertical direction or vertical height when the aircraft is on the ground, the three directions X, Y and Z being mutually orthogonal.
- (10) FIG. 1 shows an aircraft **100** that includes a fuselage **22** to each side of which a wing **24** is fixed. Under each wing **24** there is fixed at least one propulsion assembly **151** that includes a nacelle **26** including fairings **28** forming an aerodynamic exterior surface. The propulsion assembly **151** also includes an engine that is housed in the nacelle **26** and which here takes the form of a propeller engine, but which may be of some other type.
- (11) The aircraft **100** also includes a chassis (also known as a pylon) such as that represented in FIG. 5. As already described hereinabove the chassis **500** includes structural elements interconnected to form a cage and here the chassis **500** includes a plurality of formers **502** disposed one after the other parallel to the longitudinal direction X and between two successive formers **502**, and beams **504** fixed by their ends to the two successive formers **502**. Of course, the chassis **500**, the formers **502** and the beams **504** can take other forms. Such a chassis **500** constitutes a pylon for attaching the propulsion assembly **151** under the wing **24** with the propulsion assembly **151** fixed to the chassis **500** and the chassis **500** fixed to the wing **24**.

(12) FIG. 2 shows the junction between a support plate **102** and beams **50** in the context of an assembly **100** in accordance with a first embodiment of the invention. FIG. 3 shows this assembly **100** in accordance with the first embodiment of the invention and FIG. 4 shows an assembly **400** in accordance with a second embodiment of the invention.

(13) The assembly **100**, **400** is more specifically described in the case of a chassis for fixing an aircraft engine but may be used in other fields when the beams thereof must be fixed to a support plate in a globally perpendicular manner, for example. Accordingly, the support plate **102** may be a former or another plane element.

(14) The assembly **100**, **400** is therefore intended for fixing beams **50** which here are four in number although depending on the overall size, and in particular the diameters of the beams **50**, it is possible to have more or fewer, that is to say at least one.

(15) The assembly **100**, **400** thus includes the support plate **102** through which an opening **103** passes and the support plate **102** has two parallel faces that are parallel to a bearing plane P, the support plate **102** having a first face **102a** and a second face **102b** opposite the first face **102a**.

(16) The assembly **100**, **400** also includes a first fixing **104a** that comes to lie against the first face **102a** and a second fixing **104b** that comes to lie against the second face **102b**.

(17) The first fixing **104a** has a first base **106a** that comes to bear against the first face **102a** to which it is fixed directly with the aid of fixing means **108** such as bolts that pass through the support plate **102** and the first base **106a**.

(18) When the first fixing **104a** is in place against the first face **102a** the first fixing **104a** has on the side opposite the first face **102a** at least one first sleeve **110a**, here two of them, and each first sleeve **110a** receives inside it one end of a beam **50**, preferably with a force-fit and/or by welding. Each first sleeve **110a** is fastened to the first base **106a**.

(19) In the embodiment of the invention shown in FIGS. 2 to 4 one of the beams **50** is perpendicular to the support plate **102**, that is to say to the bearing plane P, but other orientations remain possible.

(20) The first fixing **104a** also includes a stud **312**, **412** that extends through the opening **103** in the support plate **102** so as to be located on the other side of the support plate **102** relative to the first base **106a**. The stud **312**, **412** is also fastened to the first base **106a**.

(21) The stud **312**, **412** includes a hole **114** with an axis **114a**. Here the hole **114** is a through-hole but it could be a blind hole. The hole **114** opens at least on the side opposite the first base **106a**, that is to say on the side of the second fixing **104b**.

(22) The second fixing **104b** has a second base **106b** that comes to bear against the second face **102b**.

(23) When the second fixing **104b** is in place against the second face **102b** the second fixing **104b** has on the side opposite the second face **102b** at least one second sleeve **110b**, here also two of them, and each second sleeve **110b** receives inside it one end of a beam **50**, preferably with a force-fit and/or by welding. Each second sleeve **110b** is fastened to the second base **106b**.

(24) In the same way as for the first fixing **104a**, in the embodiment of the invention shown in FIGS. 2 to 4 one of the beams **50** is perpendicular to the support plate **102**, that is to say to the bearing plane P, but other orientations remain possible.

(25) The second fixing **104b** also includes a hollow housing **314**, **414** inside the second fixing **104b** and in which the stud **312**, **412** of the first fixing **104a** is housed.

(26) The housing **314**, **414** includes a clamping wall **316**, **416** that has through it a hole **316a**, **416a** facing, that is to say aligned with, the hole **114** of the stud **312**, **412**. The clamping wall **316**, **416** then faces the hole **114** in the stud **312**, **412** and is preferably perpendicular to the axis **114a** of the hole **114**.

(27) The assembly **100** also includes a clamping screw **118** that has a head and a threaded shank, with the threaded shank screwed into the hole **114**, which is threaded for this purpose, causing the head to bear against the clamping wall **316**, **416**, which is therefore sandwiched between the head

of the clamping screw **118** and the stud **312**, **412**. The threaded shank of the clamping screw **118** is therefore introduced into the hole **316a**, **416a** and screwed into the hole **114** of the stud **312**, **412**.

(28) The second fixing **104b** is therefore not fixed directly to the support plate **102** but clamped by means of the first fixing **104a**.

(29) The axis **114a** of the hole **114** is at an angle α to the bearing plane P between 10° and 80° inclusive and preferably between 30° and 60° inclusive.

(30) Such an arrangement makes it possible to free up the space that perpendicularly faces the support plate **102**, to place therein sleeves **110a-b** which can therefore be perpendicular to the support plate **102**.

(31) In the case of a chassis **500** for an engine for an aircraft **100** and in the situation where a beam **50** on each side of the support plate **102** is perpendicular to the support plate **102**, tension and shear forces that are transmitted through the chassis **500** are transferred across the clamping screw **118** and the shoulder of the first fixing **104a**.

(32) In the embodiments from FIGS. **3** and **4** the hole **114** is coaxial with one of the sleeves **110a** of the first fixing **104a**, which facilitates production of said hole **114**.

(33) In the first embodiment of the invention the head of the clamping screw **118** is housed in a bushing **120** of the second fixing **104b** that here is cylindrical. Although this is not the case in the second embodiment of the invention, a bushing of this kind may equally be fitted. Here, the bushing **120** is coaxial with the axis **114a** of the hole **114**.

(34) One of the cylindrical surfaces of the bushing **120** carries a first thread for screwing in an additional beam **52**. To this end, one end of the additional beam **52** carries a second thread complementary to the first thread in order for them to cooperate.

(35) In the embodiment of the invention shown in FIG. **3** the exterior surface of the bushing **120** is externally threaded and the additional beam **52** is internally threaded.

(36) The stud **312**, **412** has a preferably cylindrical exterior surface **312a**, **412a** that fits inside an interior surface **314a**, **414a** of the housing **314**, **414** to guide movement in translation of the two fixings **104a-b** relative to one another.

(37) In the first embodiment of the invention the stud **312** has an exterior surface **312a** and the housing **314** has an interior surface **314a** that are both parallel to the axis **114a** of the hole **114** and are therefore at the same angle α to the bearing plane P. Each of the exterior surface **312a** and the interior surface **314a** preferably takes the form of a cylindrical surface coaxial with the axis **114a** of the hole **114**.

(38) In the second embodiment of the invention the stud **412** has an exterior surface **412a** and the housing **414** has an interior surface **414a** that are both perpendicular to the bearing plane P. In the case of a chassis **500** for an engine of an aircraft **100** this enables transfer of shear forces exclusively into the support plate **102**. Each of the exterior surface **412a** and the interior surface **414a** preferably takes the form of a cylindrical surface perpendicular to the bearing plane P.

(39) In the embodiments of the invention shown in FIGS. **3** and **4** the clamping screw **118** is tightened against the clamping wall **316**, **416** via a washer **122**.

(40) In the second embodiment of the invention the head of the clamping screw **118** is prevented from rotating by immobilizing means **124**. Such immobilizing means **124** can also be fitted in the first embodiment of the invention.

(41) Here the immobilizing means **124** comprise a hexagonal ring **124a** that is threaded around the hexagonal head of the clamping screw **118** and includes an extension **124** that is pierced and receives an immobilizing screw **124c** that is screwed into a nut **124d** immobilized in the second fixing **104b**.

(42) The immobilizing means **124** may take any other form known to the person skilled in the art. In the case of a chassis **500** for fixing the propulsion assembly **151** to the wing **24** the chassis **500** therefore includes a plurality of formers **502** and a plurality of beams **504** with the beams **504** fixed to the formers **502** by means of assemblies **100**, **400** as described hereinabove, with each former

502 constituting a support plate **102** and each sleeve **110a-b** receiving inside it one end of a beam **504**.

(43) While at least one exemplary embodiment of the present invention(s) is disclosed herein, it should be understood that modifications, substitutions and alternatives may be apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art and can be made without departing from the scope of this disclosure. This disclosure is intended to cover any adaptations or variations of the exemplary embodiment(s). In addition, in this disclosure, the terms “comprise” or “comprising” do not exclude other elements or steps, the terms “a” or “one” do not exclude a plural number, and the term “or” means either or both. Furthermore, characteristics or steps which have been described may also be used in combination with other characteristics or steps and in any order unless the disclosure or context suggests otherwise. This disclosure hereby incorporates by reference the complete disclosure of any patent or application from which it claims benefit or priority.

Claims

1. An assembly for fixing beams comprising: a support plate through which an opening passes and having a first face and a second face opposite the first face, the first and second faces being parallel to a bearing plane, a first fixing including: a first base fixed against the first face by fixing means, on a side opposite the first face, at least one first sleeve configured to receive, inside the at least one first sleeve, one end of a beam, and a stud extending through said opening and including a hole with an axis, a second fixing including a second base bearing against the second face and, on a side opposite the second face, at least one second sleeve fastened to the second base and configured to receive, inside the at least one second sleeve, one end of a beam, a housing in which said stud is housed and which includes a clamping wall through which passes a hole facing said hole of said stud, and a clamping screw screwed into the hole of the stud and sandwiching the clamping wall, an axis of the hole being at an angle (α) to the bearing plane between 10° and 80° inclusive.
 2. The assembly according to claim 1, wherein the hole is coaxial with a sleeve of the first fixing.
 3. The assembly according to claim 1, wherein a head of the clamping screw is housed in a bushing of the second fixing, the bushing having a cylindrical surface which carries a first thread, wherein the assembly further comprises an additional beam with an end having a second thread complementary to the first thread.
 4. The assembly according to claim 1, wherein the stud has an exterior surface that fits inside an interior surface of the housing, and wherein the exterior surface and the interior surface are parallel to an axis of the hole.
 5. The assembly according to claim 1, wherein the stud has an exterior surface that fits inside an interior surface of the housing, and wherein the exterior surface and the interior surface are both perpendicular to the bearing plane.
 6. The assembly according to claim 1, wherein the angle is between 30° and 60° inclusive.
 7. A chassis for fixing a propulsion assembly to a wing of an aircraft, said chassis comprising: a plurality of formers, a plurality of beams, a plurality of the assembly of claim 1, wherein the beams are fixed to the formers by the assemblies, each former constituting a support plate and each sleeve receiving an end of the beams.
 8. An aircraft comprising: the chassis according to claim 7, a propulsion assembly, and a wing, the propulsion assembly fixed to the chassis and the chassis fixed to the wing.
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